OCS-004 — Constitutional Semantics

Status: Foundational

Authority: Constitutional

Depends on:

- OCS-000 — Constitutional Alphabet
- OCS-001 — Constitutional Grammar
- OCS-002 — Constitutional Logic
- OCS-003 — Constitutional Mathematics

Purpose

This specification defines the constitutional semantics of Organodynamics.

The Constitutional Alphabet defines the primitives.

The Constitutional Grammar defines how primitives compose.

The Constitutional Logic defines how constitutional conclusions are derived.

The Constitutional Mathematics defines their formal structure.

This specification defines how constitutional constructs acquire, preserve, and communicate meaning.

Every subsequent specification SHALL conform to these semantic rules.

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1. Constitutional Semantics

Semantics is the constitutional interpretation of a construct within its context.

Semantics SHALL exist independently of:

Implementation

Programming language

Storage model

Communication protocol

Presentation layer

User interface

Semantics SHALL remain reconstructable.

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2. Semantic Unit

The smallest semantic unit SHALL be a Constitutional Statement.

A Constitutional Statement SHALL express exactly one constitutional meaning.

Compound meanings SHALL be represented as relationships between Constitutional Statements.

Implementations SHALL NOT encode multiple unrelated meanings within a single semantic unit.

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3. Semantic Identity

Every semantic unit SHALL possess constitutional identity.

Changing representation SHALL NOT create new semantic identity.

Changing constitutional meaning SHALL create a new semantic version.

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4. Semantic Context

Meaning SHALL always be interpreted within Context.

Context SHALL explicitly define:

Scope

Relevant assumptions

Relevant relationships

Applicable constitutional version

Known limitations

Removing Context SHALL reduce semantic validity.

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5. Semantic Scope

Every constitutional meaning SHALL declare its scope.

Possible scopes include:

Local

Shared

Canonical

Historical

Experimental

Derived

Meaning SHALL NOT silently migrate between scopes.

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6. Semantic Dependencies

Every constitutional meaning SHALL expose its dependencies.

Dependencies MAY include:

Evidence

Interpretation

Relationships

Historical Events

Experiments

Canonical Definitions

Dependencies SHALL remain observable.

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7. Semantic Stability

Meaning MAY evolve.

Semantic evolution SHALL preserve:

Identity

Historical continuity

Explanation

Traceability

Semantic evolution SHALL NEVER overwrite previous interpretation.

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8. Semantic Ambiguity

Ambiguity is a constitutional condition.

Ambiguity SHALL be represented explicitly.

Every ambiguity SHALL identify:

Competing interpretations

Supporting evidence

Missing evidence

Required investigation

Ambiguity SHALL NOT be silently resolved.

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9. Semantic Equivalence

Two constitutional expressions SHALL be semantically equivalent only when they preserve:

Meaning

Context

Intent

Historical interpretation

Evidence

Equivalent wording SHALL NOT imply semantic equivalence.

Equivalent semantics MAY exist across different languages.

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10. Semantic Drift

Semantic Drift occurs when constitutional meaning changes without explicit constitutional evolution.

Implementations SHALL detect semantic drift whenever possible.

Detected semantic drift SHALL generate a constitutional event.

Silent semantic drift constitutes constitutional failure.

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11. Semantic Composition

Complex meanings SHALL emerge through explicit semantic composition.

Composition SHALL preserve:

Meaning of constituent units

Relationship semantics

Historical traceability

Context inheritance

Composition SHALL remain explainable.

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12. Semantic Decomposition

Every constitutional meaning SHALL be decomposable.

Decomposition SHALL terminate in Constitutional Primitives defined by OCS-000.

Semantic decomposition SHALL preserve constitutional interpretation.

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13. Semantic Continuity

Meaning SHALL remain continuous across:

Version changes

Migration

Serialization

Translation

Implementation replacement

Builder replacement

Artificial Intelligence replacement

Loss of semantic continuity constitutes constitutional failure.

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14. Semantic Validation

Every constitutional meaning SHALL be capable of validation.

Validation SHALL determine:

Whether meaning remains reconstructable.

Whether context remains sufficient.

Whether evidence remains attributable.

Whether historical interpretation remains explainable.

Validation SHALL remain implementation-independent.

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15. Semantic Translation

Meaning MAY be expressed through multiple representations.

Examples include:

Natural language

Formal specification

Executable model

Diagram

Graph

Mathematical notation

Translation SHALL preserve constitutional semantics.

Representation SHALL remain secondary.

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16. Semantic Preservation

Preservation SHALL prioritize:

Meaning

before

Representation.

If representation changes while meaning remains intact,

constitutional integrity is preserved.

If representation remains identical while meaning changes,

constitutional integrity has been violated.

17. Semantic Invariants

The following SHALL remain invariant across every constitutional implementation:

Meaning is explainable.

Meaning is traceable.

Meaning is reconstructable.

Meaning is challengeable.

Meaning is revisable.

Meaning is attributable.

Violation of any invariant SHALL invalidate semantic conformance.

Conformance

An implementation conforms to OCS-004 if two independent implementations, operating through different technologies and representations, consistently preserve equivalent constitutional semantics.

Equivalent representation is not required.

Equivalent computation is not required.

Equivalent constitutional meaning is required.

Constitutional Principle

Meaning is the only constitutional artifact that every implementation is obligated to preserve.

Everything else—

representations,

interfaces,

algorithms,

technologies,

protocols,

and implementations—

exists only in service of preserving Meaning.

End of Specification OCS-004